

Petr Švihlík

VP of Engineering

Building high-performing teams, systems, and technical strategy

📍 Brno, Czechia [in linkedin.com/in/svihlik](https://www.linkedin.com/in/svihlik) github.com/petrsvihlik petrsvihlik.com

PROFILE

VP of Engineering leading a ~60-person product engineering organization at Kentico, a global DXP/CMS vendor — owning engineering strategy, org design, people systems, AI transformation, and SaaS platform operations. I create clarity, trust, and alignment: translating strategy into execution while giving teams the ownership and autonomy they need to do their best work. Most effective where technical depth, people leadership, and strategic thinking intersect. Strong bias toward action and learning by doing.

TOP SKILLS

Strategic Thinking

Analytical Thinking

Communication

Thought Leadership

Claude Code & Agentic AI

Engineering Management

Org Design (Team Topologies)

AI Transformation

Azure & SaaS Operations

Developer Experience

.NET

Open Source

EXPERIENCE

2023 – Present

VP of Engineering · Kentico — Brno, Czechia

- Engineering executive for a global DXP/CMS vendor. Own engineering strategy, org design, people systems, AI transformation, and SaaS platform operations across a ~60-engineer product organization; report to the CPO.
- Built Kentico's engineering career architecture from the ground up: dual IC/EM tracks, job tiers, role definitions, promotion process, and a merit-based compensation system with annual market-benchmarked salary methodology (3 consecutive cycles).
 - Led company-wide AI transformation: adoption programs and budget governance, a tier-linked Engineering Management AI Baseline, provider-agnostic tooling strategy, and internal automation.
 - Drove KentiCopilot, an agentic AI product built on the Model Context Protocol (MCP), enabling end-to-end agentic scenarios over the CMS; report progress directly to the CEO with checkpoint-gated delivery.
 - Own SaaS reliability and security posture: incident management analysis, uptime reporting, and Azure cost optimization — cut cloud spend by ~10% through improved forecasting and workload optimization.
 - Co-designed and executed a Team Topologies-based reorganization of the product org into five divisions; authored division charters, identified and onboarded two new division leaders, and now lead Platform Engineering directly.
 - Represent engineering to strategic partners and enterprise customers: led the technical response retaining Kentico's top implementation partner; negotiated SLA terms for government SaaS procurement.

2021 – 2023

Senior Software Development Engineer · Microsoft — Prague, Czechia

- Azure Communication Services (ACS) | Developer Success team. A deliberate swing back to hands-on engineering at global scale — senior IC by choice (declined a parallel EM offer) before returning to executive leadership.
- Led development of SDKs and shared AuthN/AuthZ primitives for Azure Communication Services.
 - Served as Developer Experience panelist, influencing public APIs and SDK design across ACS — collaborating with the Azure SDK architects on API design and review.
 - Conducted REST & SDK API reviews and privacy & security reviews for globally distributed cloud services; defined best practices for authentication, authorization, and identity management.
 - Key projects: ACS/Microsoft Teams interoperability; Identity service idempotence and reliability improvements.

2017 – 2021	Head of Developer Relations · Kentico — Brno, Czechia ● Founded and scaled Kentico's Developer Relations function from zero to a high-impact team of 5. ● Defined DevRel, Developer Experience, and Developer Marketing strategy aligned with business goals. ● Built and governed a large-scale open-source ecosystem (120+ repositories, SDKs & samples across ~15 tech stacks). ● Owned all developer-facing communication: content, events, sponsorships, MVP program, and community engagement; introduced OKRs and translated strategy into execution.
2015 – 2017	Developer Advocate · Kentico — Amsterdam, Netherlands ● Defined early developer community strategy around Kentico products; led and coordinated open-source initiatives across the company. ● Drove community engagement, contributor growth, and technical feedback loops. ● Delivered technical talks, workshops, and authored developer-focused content.
2014 – 2015	Software Engineer · TrueLime — Breda, Netherlands ● Delivered enterprise solutions for global clients: cloud architecture, CI/CD, scalable .NET systems, CRM customizations, and complex integrations.
2012 – 2014	Technical Leader · Kentico — Brno, Czechia ● Led platform and DevOps teams responsible for CI, tooling, and core CMS capabilities (data engine, security, APIs, performance, scalability); owned backlog prioritization as Product Owner.
2007 – 2012	Software Developer, later Senior Software Developer · Kentico — Brno, Czechia
2002 – 2007	Early Career — Software Development & Teaching — CSJu, CC Systems, eMule

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

2015 – Present	WopiHost — Maintainer Maintainer of WopiHost, the leading open-source .NET implementation of the WOPI protocol (200+ GitHub stars), integrating Office Online, Collabora, and OnlyOffice.
2018 – 2020	Consulted / opposed 4 diploma & bachelor theses, Faculty of Informatics, Masaryk University .
2022	Volunteer personal assistant (3 days, 24/7) for a person with paraplegia, Liga Vozíčkářů .

EDUCATION

2008 – 2011	Bc., Applied Informatics — Faculty of Informatics, Masaryk University, Brno.
2006 – 2008	Information Technology — Faculty of Information Technology, Brno University of Technology.
2002 – 2006	Programming — High School of Applied Cybernetics, Hradec Králové.

LANGUAGES

Czech — native
English — full professional proficiency
Spanish — elementary proficiency
Dutch — elementary proficiency

CERTIFICATIONS

Certificate in Advanced English (CAE)
MCSD, MCSA, MCPD, MCTS, MCP
CCNA

PERSONAL

Citizenship: Czech
Born: 1987
Residence: Brno, Czechia (EU)